

the 1990s, the number of people in the world who are under 15 years of age has increased from 1.1 billion to 1.6 billion, and the number of people aged 65 and over has increased from 0.4 billion to 0.6 billion (United Nations 2002).

There is a growing awareness of the need to address the needs of the young and the old. The United Nations has developed the Millennium Development Goals (MDGs) to address the needs of the world's population by the year 2015. The MDGs are a set of eight goals that are designed to address the most pressing development issues of the world. The goals are: to eradicate poverty, to achieve universal primary education, to promote gender equality, to reduce child mortality, to improve maternal health, to combat HIV/AIDS, malaria and other diseases, to ensure environmental sustainability, and to develop a global partnership for development (United Nations 2002).

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